

Apple Airplay for TV

Apple is wooing TV manufacturers to ship their new sets with the Airplay software allowing Apple to stream content from its devices

bit slow, even using Android 2.2, and the display, isn't as vivid and crisp as we'd like. Compared to newer phones like the HTC Desire HD the X10i feels its age, especially with the ultra wide bezel that we do not like. Additionally, the camera on the X10i supports touch to focus but touching also clicks off a shot after focussing – it would be nice to have individual control over the shutter like the Samsung Galaxy S and HTC phones. The camera button on the X10i is also a little soft, with less feedback.

Next we looked at the Samsung i9000 a.k.a. the Galaxy S. Although the phone is entirely plastic, it feels extremely well built and is very light – a mere 119 grams. In fact, for a phone with a 4-inch display, this is pretty incredible, especially when you consider the excellent build quality. In terms of weight, it's hard to beat the HTC Desire Z. Built with liberal amounts of aluminium the Desire Z doesn't feel entirely solid, thanks in part to its lift and slide down hardware QWERTY keypad. The Samsung Galaxy S feels more likely to survive a drop, amongst these.

The Motorola XT720 is another solid device, with a lot of metal in the outer body. The XT720 is blessed with a decent interface, and it feels a bit snappier than the Motorola Milestone. The camera on the XT720 is the only one to feature both a Xenon and LED flash. Even the cables bundled are of the highest grade we've seen, and the XT720 also bundled an HDMI cable. The Motorola XT800 is supposed to be an XT720 successor, but to be honest, we find the phone not as attractive looking.

The Venue, with a 4.1-inch display, feels bulkier than the HTC Desire HD that has a 4.3-inch display. The interface on the Venue seems to lag at times, and there is definitely lag when using the camera. Dells interface is not as exciting as the HTC Sense UI and feels a little archaic in comparison. In fact, we find the Galaxy S' interface lacking as well. Samsung's TouchWiz interface doesn't feel as refined as the Sense UI.

The Desire Z has a QWERTY mechanism that feels like it may not wear well, and should develop play with hard use. While an S-LCD is advertised on the Desire Z, it doesn't look as gorgeous as the S-LCD on the original HTC Desire – we wonder why. However, colours are richer than the Desire HD, and when viewed from an angle,

to be productive, since it takes a lot of effort to type anything and is not as effortless, (and therefore the keypad isn't as usable), as we'd like.

The Desire HD feels like an expensive phone with its curvy body and large 4.3-inch display. The body is entirely metal, except for the small SIM/memory card cover on the bottom of the phone that is plastic, and the plastic battery cover. The battery cover slides out from the side, and the battery itself slides into the metal uni-body, meaning using a larger



HTC Desire HD

juice, for it just gives you a day's worth. The display is pretty good for a non S-LCD/AMOLED unit, but colours aren't as vivid as we'd like, though to be honest, the Desire HDs display looks better than the HTC HD 7.

The camera is an 8-megapixel unit with dual LED flash units, but shockingly, there's no dedicated camera button, though the touch interface works perfectly.

Performance

Both HTC phones have tinny, but powerful loudspeakers, unfortunately there is too much power in the treble, and not enough of the mid-range. When using the handsfree, music quality is good. The Desire HD has a good antenna, and in zone one there is near-perfect clarity, and the volume level is also good. In zone three, voice quality remains good, but we faced one disconnection, that was not repeated though we tried thrice. The Galaxy S is also commendable in this regard, and in terms of loudspeaker clarity and volume, it blows both HTC phones out of the water. In fact the tiny vent for the loudspeaker outputs surprisingly punchy sound. Using the handsfree unit, we

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colours do not fade as much. The Desire Z has a pretty decent camera button and half press (to autofocus) is quite intuitive. The QWERTY keypad isn't however, and we find the keys too hard

capacity battery is not possible, even brands like Mugen Power offer a 1300 mAh unit for the Desire HD – a mere 70 mAh more than the stock battery. And you will feel the lack of

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